Understanding Your Care Pathway in the Netherlands

The goal is to help patients actively navigate their care journey once they are in the system.

Suggested guiding questions

1. Referrals and process

- How do referrals work in the Netherlands?
- Can I choose my hospital or specialist?
- Can I change doctors?

2. Waiting times

- How long should I expect to wait for appointments or treatment?
- What can I do if I feel the process is too slow?
- Is it normal to wait between steps?

3. Treatment decisions

- How are treatment decisions made?
- Can I ask for alternative options?
- Do I have time to decide?

4. Second opinions

- Am I allowed to get a second opinion? Also in another country.
- How do I request one?
- Will it be covered by insurance?

5. Additional care and support

- What additional services can I access?
- Psychological care
- Physiotherapy
- Nutrition advice
- Fertility support
- How do I get referred to these services?

6. Communication and understanding

- What if I don’t understand medical terminology?
- Can I request explanations in simpler language?
- Are there English-speaking healthcare providers?